

词汇: *senses* 感官

- 1 Many of us grew up learning that humans have five senses: sight, hearing, taste, smell and touch – an idea dating back to the Ancient Greek philosopher Aristotle. But what if this list is incomplete? A sense is anything that can give your body information about the outside world, and some of these don't neatly fit into the traditional five. Modern scientists estimate there may be up to 33 different senses.
- 2 One sense that doesn't fit into one of the five boxes is **proprioception**. This is the sense of where your body parts are in space. Thanks to this sense, you can touch your nose with your eyes closed and walk around in the dark – you know where your legs are without looking. Then there's **interoception** which helps you sense things inside your body, like hunger and an increased heart rate. And don't **take** your sense of balance **for granted**. Balance relies on fluid in your inner ear to help you stay **upright** – this is what's called **vestibular perception**.
- 3 And the traditional five senses might not be as simple as they seem. Touch, the sense we associate with our hands and **tactile** sensations, also encompasses the sensation of pain, temperature and **itch**. To perceive the flavours in food and drink, you need a combination of taste, smell and touch to get the full experience – it's not all about the **taste buds** on your tongue! It is actually smell that contributes most of what we perceive as taste, so when a person suffers **olfactory** loss, they often can't enjoy food as much, according to a 2022 study published in *Foods* by Fjaeldstad and Smith.
- 4 Until recently, philosophers and scientists have studied each of the traditional five senses in isolation, but researchers at the University of London's Centre for the Study of the Senses have more of a **multisensory** approach – the senses are all working together to create an overall picture. In their 'Rethinking the Senses' project, they found that our perception of salt, sweet and sour flavours is reduced when there is **white noise**, but our perception of **umami** is not. This means that sound can enhance flavour, and that umami-rich foods like tomato juice might taste better on a plane.

- 5 So, perhaps humans are far more **sensory** creatures than Aristotle ever imagined. From balance and body awareness to the way sound can change flavour, our senses are constantly working together in ways we rarely notice.

测验与练习

一、为本文选择总结句。

- a. Humans experience their senses in isolation.
- b. Each of the senses can influence each other.
- c. Humans may have more senses than originally thought.

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

- 1. Aristotle thought the list of five senses was incomplete.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
- 2. Which sense helps us know when to eat?
 - a. proprioception
 - b. interoception
 - c. vestibular perception
- 3. Hearing is experienced only using the ears.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
- 4. Researchers at the Centre for the Study of the Senses research the senses in isolation.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
- 5. What does the 'Rethinking the Senses' project tell us?
 - a. Sweet and salty foods might taste better on the ground than on a plane.
 - b. Our hearing and taste senses don't interact.
 - c. Airlines should only serve sweet and salty foods.

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

It's easy to **1)** _____ how your senses are working together to create your experience of the outside world. We don't think about the mechanisms that are keeping us standing **2)** _____, or how your body knows when to scratch a(n) **3)** _____ on your skin. Modern scientists are beginning to view our senses from a(n) **4)** _____ approach. Some researchers found that **5)** _____ can enhance the perception of umami-rich foods.

take for granted	multisensory	white noise
upright		itch
proprioception		tactile

(答案见词汇表后)

词汇表

proprioception	本体感觉
interoception	内感受
take (something) for granted	认为（某事）理所当然
upright	直立的
vestibular perception	前庭觉
tactile	触觉的
itch	痒
taste buds	味蕾
olfactory	嗅觉的
multisensory	多感官的
white noise	白噪音
umami	（食物的）鲜味
sensory	感觉的，感官的

答案

一、为本文选择总结句。

c. Humans may have more senses than originally thought.

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **b. False.** *Many of us grew up learning that **humans have five senses**: sight, hearing, taste, smell and touch – **an idea dating back to the Ancient Greek philosopher Aristotle.***

2. **b.** *Then there's **interoception** which helps you sense things inside your body, like **hunger** and an increased **heart rate**.*

3. **c. Not given.** The mechanisms of touch and taste are mentioned but not hearing.

4. **b. False.** *... researchers at the University of London's Centre for the Study of the Senses have more of a **multisensory approach** – the **senses are all working together** to create an overall picture.*

5. **a.** In the study, they found that perception of salt, sweet and sour flavours is reduced when there is white noise, but our perception of umami is not, so we can infer that sweet and salty food might taste better on the ground than on a plane, where white noise reduces their flavour.

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

It's easy to **take for granted** how your senses are working together to create your experience of the outside world. We don't think about the mechanisms that are keeping us standing **upright**, or how your body knows when to scratch an **itch** on your skin. Modern scientists are beginning to view our senses from a **multisensory** approach. Some researchers found that **white noise** can enhance the perception of umami-rich foods.